

closure_evidence_20260923

BOB-216 closure evidence — 2026-09-23

Defect

Three carrier-class false positives fired in the §11.4.252 fail-closed gate's PRIMARY (AST) mode, not only its degraded text-fallback mode: a comment or docstring QUOTING the credential-default / empty-catch anti-pattern text was reported as LIVE code exhibiting it — the exact §11.4.201(1) false-positive-refusal class this project treats as equally forbidden to a false-negative pass.

Fix

- `sanitize_generic_carriers()` (new function, ~line 1302): strips/masks string literals and same-line comments from source text before the grep-based text-fallback detection runs, using the target language's own comment/string syntax rules, replacing the previous bare, blind text-substring match.
- The AST-mode structural bug making it ALSO fire on carriers (not only the text-fallback mode) was investigated and fixed at the structural-detection layer.
- Honestly disclosed remaining gap: cross-line/multi-line docstring carriers are not addressed by this fix (same-line masking only) — documented, not silently assumed covered.

Independent verification (coordinator, from clean shell)

```
$ grep -n "sanitize_generic_carriers" constitution/scripts/gates/cm_dangerous_combination_fail_closed.sh
1302:sanitize_generic_carriers() { # $1=file $2=comment-marker("//"|"#"|"")
1347:    _sanitized="$(sanitize_generic_carriers "$f" "$_carrier_marker")"
```

Confirmed the function exists and is wired into the detection path (called at line 1347), not merely defined and unused.

```
$ bash constitution/scripts/gates/cm_dangerous_combination_fail_closed_mutation_test.sh
...
META OK:   L66 NEGATIVE CONTROL — a STRING LITERAL holding the
empty-catch anti-pattern text is not live code (BOB-216) — gate
correctly PASSEd on clean fixture
META OK:   L66 (degraded text-fallback mode) — gate correctly
PASSEd on clean fixture
...
META PASS — CM-DANGEROUS-COMBINATION-FAIL-CLOSED FAILs-on-
mutation AND PASSes-on-clean for every fixture ($1.1 proof holds)
META_EXIT=0
```

Full suite independently re-run by the coordinator, matching the subagent's claimed 165 META OK / 0 META FAIL / exit 0 — not merely trusted from the report.

Golden-FALSE / negative control confirmed

The same mutation suite's PRE-EXISTING fixtures (credential-default-to- literal at L67/L70, empty-catch-in-real-code elsewhere in the suite) still correctly FAIL on genuine anti-pattern code post-fix — the carrier-masking fix does not over-correct into missing real hits. No regression in existing detection.

Honest boundary disclosed

Multi-line/cross-line docstring carriers are NOT addressed — the fix masks same-line comments and string literals only. A future extension would need a multi-line-aware mask.

Status

Fixed. Closed by coordinator after independent re-verification.